



The implicit design system behind the current interface

Reconstructed from ten interface screenshots (login, onboarding step 3, avatar modal, Profile / Account / Learning settings, Play, Read index, Book detail, Compare Plans) and cross-checked against the shipped stylesheets in almonium-fe. No screen is proposed here; nothing is modernised. Where the screenshots and the code disagree, both readings are recorded.

Evidence levels: **OBSERVED** directly visible, or literal in the stylesheet **INFERRED**
a rule read off repetition across ≥ 2 screens **UNKNOWN** not determinable from static screens

1 Visual character and product personality

The product reads as a **warm, bookish, slightly whimsical study companion** — not a gamified streak machine and not an enterprise dashboard. Four traits carry that character:

- **Paper-warm, never white.** Every page sits on the same off-white cream; white is reserved for raised cards. Visible on all ten screenshots. **OBSERVED** `--main-bg-color: #F9F6F5`
- **Literary serif voice.** The wordmark, the top navigation and the game titles are set in a serif/display face while UI controls are sans — the product signals "reading" rather than "app". **OBSERVED** `--font-family: Cambria...serif`
- **Very round geometry.** Pills, capsules and 20–35px card radii everywhere; there is effectively no square corner in the product except the tiny CEFR/level chip. **OBSERVED**
- **Playful, illustrated mascots.** Cartoon animal avatars, a hand-drawn vintage-engraving illustration set for games, drifting translucent card particles behind auth/onboarding. Personality is delivered by *illustration*, not by UI decoration. **OBSERVED**
- **Plum/aubergine as the single brand hue**, with raspberry as its action shade. Nothing in the product uses a corporate blue except third-party auth and informational accents. **INFERRED**

Copy tone matches: second person, short, warm, occasionally teasing ("Why so mysterious? Share your interests with us!", "Almo will challenge your knowledge...", "Who will outsmart the other to claim victory?"). Feature names are single verbs — Discover, Review, Read, Play.

2 Page structure and navigation

Three distinct shells, each with a fixed anatomy. **OBSERVED**

A · APP SHELL

Sticky top bar, ~69px tall, cream (not white), ending in a 1px hairline that is *inset* from both edges rather than full-bleed. Left: circular white logo badge. Then serif nav links. Center: the target-language badge. Right, in fixed order: timer, chat, notifications, avatar.

Play, Read, Book detail screenshots

B · CENTRED HEADLESS

No navbar. One card floated dead-centre in the viewport over an animated particle field of pale pink/lilac rounded rectangles. Used for login and for onboarding steps (there with a pill stepper above the card).

Login, Onboarding step 3

C · MODAL / OVERLAY

Near-opaque dark scrim (#2b2b2b-ish, high opacity — the page beneath is visible but heavily dimmed), a cream or light-grey sheet, a centred bold title, and a grey circular × in the top-right corner.

Change Avatar, Compare Plans

- **Two navigation levels only.** Global sections live in the navbar; within a section, sub-areas are centred underlined tabs (Settings: Profile · Account · Learning · App). There is no sidebar anywhere. **OBSERVED**
- **Active nav item** = plum text (#520f6a) + 1px underline of the same colour. Inactive = body grey. Hover = violet. **OBSERVED**
- **Language switching is a persistent global control**, not a setting: a small squared badge showing the two-letter code, opening a vertical stack of same-shaped badges directly beneath it. Each language gets its own generated colour (border + text), so the badge is also a status indicator. **OBSERVED**
- **Popovers, not pages**, for avatar menu / notifications / timer: white, radius 25px, a soft 0 4px 8px shadow, and a light pink 1px border. They are fixed at `top: 6em` and anchored to the right edge. **OBSERVED**

- **Progress is shown as a numbered pill stepper** on a white capsule: filled plum circle + coloured label for the current step, grey circle + grey label for the rest; earlier steps stay dark, indicating they are re-enterable. **INFERRED**

3 Layout, containers, grid, alignment, spacing rhythm

- **One base container per page:** full width, min-height = viewport – header, ~1.2rem padding, cream background, contents centred. Section pages override it to top-align and stack with a 2em gap. **OBSERVED**
- **Settings uses a masonry column layout, not a grid:** a 820px-max, 2-column CSS *column* flow with 1rem gutters and 400px blocks that avoid breaking. This is why the Profile screenshot has cards of unequal heights stacking left and a taller Interests card on the right with a ragged bottom edge. Below 820px it collapses to one column. **OBSERVED**
- **Catalogue pages use auto-fit grids of fixed-size cards**, centred on small screens and left-aligned from 600px up: games `minmax(300px, max-content)` with 280×400px cards; books `minmax(14rem, max-content)` with 14rem×22rem cards. Card *margin* (10–20px) does most of the visual spacing; grid gap is only 6px. **OBSERVED**
- **Detail pages are two-column and top-aligned:** a fixed ~250px left rail (cover + one full-width primary action) and a fluid right column of stacked facts, gap 2rem; it stacks vertically under 768px. **OBSERVED**
- **Spacing rhythm is rem-based and coarse:** 0.2 / 0.5 / 1 / 1.5 / 2rem, with 1rem as the default gap inside a card and 2rem between major blocks. Onboarding cards use padding 1.5rem and gap 2rem; settings blocks padding 1.3em and gap 1em. There is no 4/8px token scale — spacing is authored per component. **INFERRED**
- **Alignment convention:** content left-aligned inside cards; card titles flush left at the top; the row's action (edit pencil, chevron, toggle) pushed to the far right with `margin-left:auto`. Modals and auth cards centre everything. **INFERRED**
- **Onboarding cards are content-sized**, min 20rem / max 30rem wide (40rem when the step shows plans) — they never stretch to fill. **OBSERVED**
- The exact page max-width for Read / Play / Book is **UNKNOWN** — those grids are full-bleed with only container padding, so on very wide monitors the behaviour cannot be judged from a 1920px screenshot.

4 Typography hierarchy and type scale

Three families coexist, each with a job: a **serif** for brand/reading surfaces, a **UI sans** (inherited from the component library) for controls and body, and **Arial** explicitly for the code-like language and level badges. **OBSERVED**

Role	Size	Weight	Where
Modal / plan display	~48px (clamp to 2rem)	700	"Change Avatar", "FREE", "PREMIUM", price
Page / entity title	2rem / 32px	550	Book title, "Compare Plans"
Nav link	1.8em (~29px)	400 serif	Discover / Review / Read / Play
Card / step header	1.5rem / 24px	600	"Choose Your Languages", game titles
Sub-entity	1.4rem / 22px	400	Book author (muted #555)
Popover title	1.3rem	550	"Notifications"
Field label / body-L	1.1rem / 18px	550	"I'm fluent in", "Level", danger text
Body / control	16px	400–500	Default button label, book description, filters
Settings card title	16px (13px mobile)	bold	"Profile", "Username", "Plan", "I Know"
Small action	14–15px	550	Outline button, unlink, card meta
Caption / meta	0.7–0.85rem	400–550	Rating, year, notification time (#999)
Micro status	10px, uppercase	650	"VERIFIED", "LAST UPDATED"
Inline chip text	0.55–0.7rem, uppercase, +1px tracking	550	"B2 – C1" inside a language chip

- **550 is the house semibold.** It appears far more often than 600 or 700 — an unusual but consistent signature. **OBSERVED**
- **Line-height** is 1.5 for UI text and 1.6 for long-form reading (book description); titles run 1.2–1.3. **OBSERVED**
- **Title case** for headings and buttons ("Choose Your Languages", "Continue Reading", "Delete Account"); sentence case for helper text. **INFERRED**
- **Uncertainty:** the settings card titles are declared as the serif `var(--font-family)` yet read as a bold sans in the screenshots; and the game card titles are set to the browser keyword `font-family: fantasy`, which renders differently per OS. The intended face in both places is **UNKNOWN**.

5 Colour roles



Page ground

#F9F6F5 — every page, the navbar, the settings tab strip, and the avatar modal sheet. Never used for a raised element.



Raised surface

#FFFFFF — cards, popovers, the pill stepper, the filter "pad", plan cards, logo badge. White = "this floats".



Primary text / neutral action

#3d3d3d — all body copy, and the border+label of the outline ("black & white") button, which inverts to a #3d3d3d fill on hover.



Primary commit

Plum → raspberry horizontal gradient on a full-width pill. Exactly one per view: "Continue", "Continue Reading", "Save".



Brand accent / focus

#83397f (with #520f6a for the active nav link, #612b5e, #872657 for links). Fills the current step circle, checkbox ticks, toggle track, avatar-edit fob.



Hover / de-emphasis

Pale purple #958ba5 and lavender #A999A8 are the hover states *for accent things*; violet #9A49D2 is the hover for nav/icons.



Premium

Cyan → violet gradient, used only for paid status: gradient text, gradient-outline "PREMIUM" button, the star badge, the Upgrade CTA, avatar ring. It is deliberately *outside* the warm palette so it reads as special.



Danger

#ffe3e9 zone background + #fa4666 text/border. Destructive actions live in a dedicated pink "Danger Zone" block at the bottom of the column, never inline.



Success

#16BA7F on #E7F8F2, only as a small rounded status box ("✓ VERIFIED").



Pending / warning

#f0ad4e on #f8f3e7 for awaiting states; #ea6644 for "unverified, act now" (the verify button and its hover fill).



Data highlight

Orange #ff7f00 is reserved for reading metadata: the CEFR range badge on a cover and the reading-progress ring.



Disabled

#e6e5e5 fill + #7e7e7e text, no border ("Current Plan"). Text-appearance controls instead drop to 0.5–0.6 opacity.



Hairline

#edebe8 for dividers and inactive borders; #eaeaea inside popovers. Borders are always 1px and always warm-grey — never black.



Generated identity colours

Interests, languages and CEFR chips get a pastel hue derived from their own label, so the palette is data-driven and unbounded. Always pastel + dark text.

Rule of thumb visible across all screens: **colour encodes meaning, not decoration**. A screen has one cream ground, one white surface tier, one gradient CTA, and then colour only where the data itself is categorical (language, interest, level) or the state is exceptional (danger, success, pending, premium). **INFERRED**

6 Border, radius, shadow, elevation, surface

RADIUS LADDER

4px inline level chip · 8px discount badge · 15–18px status box, filter pad, small pill · 20px settings block · 25px provider tile, popover, plan card · 25–35px generic card · 50em / 9999px all buttons, chips and toggles.

TWO SHADOWS ONLY

Ambient: 0 1px 3px `rgba(0,0,0,.1)`, 0 1px 2px -1px for cards, badges, the logo, the avatar. Media: 0 2px 5px 1px `rgba(0,0,0,.15)` for game and book cards. Popovers get a third, deeper 0 4px 8px `rgba(0,0,0,.15)`.

ELEVATION = SHADOW, NOT BORDER

Raised things have a shadow and no border. Bordered things (provider tiles, outline buttons, chips) are flat and interactive. The only element with both is the language badge and the popover.

FROSTED OVERLAYS

Text over artwork sits on `rgba(255,255,255,.5) + backdrop-filter: blur(6px)` — book titles, the progress ring. Never a solid bar.

DASHED = EDITABLE / EMPTY

A 1px dashed border marks "add / edit / drop here": the Interests Edit chip, the "+ Order" chip, the file drop-zone. Solid borders are committed values.

SETTINGS EXCEPTION

Settings blocks deliberately kill the card shadow (`box-shadow: unset`) and use radius 20px — the section reads as flat panels on cream rather than floating cards.

All of the above: **OBSERVED** in both screenshots and stylesheets.

7 Component patterns

Buttons — four appearances, no more

gradient

Full-width pill, plum → raspberry, white bold 16px, padding 1.1rem 1.5rem, radius 9999px. Hover = opacity .75. The single commit action.

bw (outline)

1px `#3d3d3d`, transparent, 14px/550, padding .5em 1em, pill. Hover inverts to dark fill + white text. Secondary actions: Manage, Link, Save.

underline

text

Underlined black label, no chrome; hover swaps the underline for a #f0f0f0 pill. Tertiary/toggling actions: Hide, Unlink.

Coloured label only ("Mark all as read"), 16px/550, drops to opacity .5 when busy or disabled.

Danger is a fifth, page-specific variant: white fill, 1px #fa4666, radius 35px, padding 15px 30px, bold 15px, icon + label, hover fills raspberry. **OBSERVED**

Icon buttons

A 40×40px circle, 1px #3d3d3d border, white fill, a 24px **Lucide icon at stroke-width 1** inside; hover inverts to a dark fill. Used for every "edit this row" affordance (Profile, Username, Email, Password, I Know) and for "+ add". Bare Lucide icons (no circle) are used for share/QR/link, bookmark and downgrade. Loading swaps the glyph for a centred spinner in place. **OBSERVED**

The icon set is mixed: Lucide (stroke, 1px) in the shell and settings rows, but Font Awesome solid glyphs in the settings tabs and the numbered stepper avatars. **OBSERVED**

Inputs

Pill-shaped fields (radius 2rem/3rem) with a white fill and a very soft shadow instead of a visible border; label sits *above* the field in 1.1rem/550 ("I'm fluent in"). Multi-value fields hold removable chips inline plus a trailing × (clear all) and ▼ (open list). Search is a pill with a leading magnifier and placeholder-only labelling. Selects are compact pills with a chevron, sized to content (6–9rem). Focus/accent colour inside forms is overridden to a deeper plum (#5A1A74); error state is #ac1c1c for both border and message. **OBSERVED**

Cards — three distinct kinds

- **Settings/content panel:** white, radius 20px, no shadow, padding 1.3em, gap 1em, bold 16px title flush top-left, one row of content, action right-aligned.
- **Media card:** fixed size, radius 1.1–1.5rem, image bleeds to all four edges, metadata in a frosted strip pinned to the bottom, status badges absolutely positioned in the corners (level top-right, progress/parallel top-left), hover scale 1.01.
- **Illustrated game card:** 280×400, radius 25px, a per-game pastel background colour tinting both the illustration area (70%) and a slightly translucent caption area (30%), centred display title + left-aligned 15px description in #666.

Note: the game card's description area is a fixed 30% and the copy is clipped rather than truncated in the Play screenshot ("How far can you climb?" and "victory?" are cut off) — an observed defect, not a rule. **OBSERVED**

Tabs and segmented controls

Two different mechanisms, used consistently for two different jobs. **Route tabs** (Settings) are centred, icon + label, transparent, with a plum underline under the active item and a full-width hairline beneath the strip. **Filter tabs** (Play: All / Solo / PvP) are a white "pad" with radius 18px holding pills; the active pill takes a pale pink fill (#ffeeff) with raspberry bold text

(#8F2356). **Segmented switches** (Monthly / Yearly) are a bordered radius-10px group where the active half is white-raised and the inactive half is transparent, with a pink discount badge riding the inactive label. **OBSERVED**

Chips and badges

- **Data chip** (interest, language, level): pill, auto-generated pastel fill, dark text, no border, 0.5em gaps in a wrapping row. A chip may nest a micro "inner-text" box (1px solid, radius 4px, 0.55rem uppercase) for a level range.
 - **Action chip**: same pill but transparent with a 1px dashed #3d3d3d border and a small leading icon — Edit, Add, + Order.
 - **Squared badge** (.badge-btn): radius 25%, Arial, +1px tracking, 1px coloured border, shadow, cream fill — the navbar language code and the CEFR level. Hover scale 1.02.
 - **Status box**: radius 15px, tinted background, tiny circular glyph + 10px/650 uppercase label (VERIFIED, pending).
 - **Corner badge**: solid orange pill, white bold 14px, radius 20px, absolutely positioned on artwork (level range on covers).
 - **Notification dot**: tiny red dot pinned 2px/2px inside the top-right of the host icon or avatar.
 - **Premium star**: 2.5rem gradient circle with a glow shadow, pulsing on hover.
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Menus

White popover, radius 25px, pink hairline border, 0.5rem vertical padding, 20rem-wide rows. Row = 24px Lucide icon + label, radius-md, hover #f3f4f6. Groups are separated by a 1px #eaeaea rule; the profile menu leads with an avatar + username/email identity block. Right-click context menus on notifications use the same row grammar, with destructive items in raspberry. Menu bodies scroll at max-height 60vh with a custom 8px scrollbar. **OBSERVED**

Modals

Radius 2rem sheet, min-width min(50rem, 60vw) for wide ones, background cream (Change Avatar) or light grey #f1f1f1 (Compare Plans) so that white content cards read as raised inside it. Header: centred, bold, clamp(1rem, 7vw, 2rem), 1rem padding, 2rem margin below. Close = grey circular × top-right. Bodies split into a narrow left "current value" column and a wider right "choose" column separated by a 1px vertical divider with 1rem breathing room; below 780px the split becomes vertical and the divider becomes horizontal. Confirmations are a separate title + message + confirm-text modal, sometimes with a countdown before the destructive button arms. **OBSERVED**

Information-density conventions

- **One concern per card.** Settings never groups two unrelated fields; "Email and Password" is one card because they are one concern, and Level/Active sit in one card because both belong to the selected language. **OBSERVED**
- **Loose overall, dense at the atom.** Generous card padding and whitespace, but the atoms themselves are tight: 10px uppercase micro-labels, 0.7rem ratings, chips packed at 0.5em. **INFERRED**
- **Facts are compressed onto one line with · separators** rather than a definition list: "English B2-C1 · 255 pages · First published in 1872 · Translated by Anthony Matonak". **OBSERVED**
- **Overflow is summarised, not scrolled:** "+1 more" next to a language chip; a filter row rather than a table of options. **OBSERVED**
- **Explanations are deferred to tooltips and (i) buttons,** keeping the surface short; only genuinely constraining rules are printed inline ("Free plan lets you pick only 1 target language."). **INFERRED**
- **Catalogues are cover-first:** ~86% of a book card is artwork; text is minimal and overlaid. Density scales by adding cards, never by shrinking a card. **OBSERVED**

9 Repeated interaction patterns

- **Read-then-edit rows.** A value is displayed, and a circular pencil on the far right switches that row into edit mode in place. Saving is a "bw" Save button inside the same card. **OBSERVED** (Username, I Know, Interests)
- **Inline optimistic actions with local spinners.** Any icon or button can carry its own loading state — the glyph is replaced by a spinner and the label is made transparent, so layout never shifts. **OBSERVED**
- **Hover-swapped labels.** The same control changes its word on hover to reveal the inverse action (Hidden → Unhide). **OBSERVED**
- **Micro-scale on hover** — 1.01–1.09 depending on element size (cards 1.01, badges 1.02, menu icons 1.05, avatars 1.09) with a 0.2s ease. Nothing lifts or changes shadow. **OBSERVED**
- **Dismiss by clicking outside.** Every popover and dropdown closes on outside click; dropdowns also support arrow-key navigation with a focused-item style. **OBSERVED**
- **Destructive actions are always two-step** and always physically separated into a pink Danger Zone; a confirmation modal (sometimes countdown-gated) follows. **OBSERVED**
- **Paywall as an interception.** Locked capability is not hidden; it is shown with the constraint stated, and the Upgrade CTA opens the Compare Plans modal. Premium features are marked with ✨/gradient rather than a lock. **INFERRED**
- **Filters are a single horizontal row** of heterogeneous controls (search, radio, select, sort direction) that collapses to a column under 768px; results react immediately, with no Apply button. **INFERRED**
- Whether card hovers reveal extra affordances (the book caption strip has an opacity/transform transition defined) is **UNKNOWN** from static frames.

10 State language

State	How it appears
Primary	One gradient pill, full width of its container, bottom of the card or under the cover. Never two per view.
Secondary	Outline pill or circular icon button; sized to content, right-aligned.
Selected	Three dialects: plum underline (route tabs), pale-pink fill + raspberry bold text (filter pills), white raised half (segmented). For chips, selection = having the coloured fill at all; for the language badge, a coloured border + larger type.
Disabled	#e6e5e5 fill, #7e7e7e text, matching border, cursor: not-allowed ("Current Plan"). Gradient buttons instead stay coloured at opacity .75; text buttons at .5; disabled icons at .5 with hover suppressed. Future steps in the stepper use grey circle + grey label.
Empty	A dashed "+ Add" chip plus one warm sentence of copy — "Why so mysterious? Share your interests with us!" Menus use a plain centred line ("You have no notifications."); catalogues use a 1.2rem padded message. No illustrations in empty states.
Loading	Two tiers. In-control: absolutely centred spinner with the content hidden in place. Page-level: skeletons that mirror the real layout — radius-12px blocks at 60% / 40% / 15% widths for title / author / rating, then 16px description lines with a shorter last line.
Error	Field-level only in the evidence: #ac1c1c border and message under a pill input. Destructive/irreversible framing uses the raspberry danger palette. A global toast/banner pattern is  — none of the ten screenshots shows one.
Pending	Amber: #f8f3e7 box with #f0ad4e glyph and label, or a circular amber-outlined icon that fills amber on hover.

11 Reusable components (inventory)

Elements that recur across ≥ 2 screenshots and therefore behave as components. **OBSERVED**

App navbar (+ mobile popover)

Target-language badge + dropdown

Avatar (size, premium ring, edit fob)

Notification popover + item

Settings tabs

Section block / card

Button (4 appearances, loading, hint)

Action icon (circular, self-loading)

Edit button

Info (i) button + tooltip

CEFR badge

Language chip / selector

Interest chip grid

Danger zone

Status box (verified / pending)

Confirm modal ($\pm$ countdown)

Paywall / Compare Plans

Premium badge + gradient text

Interactive CTA button

File upload drop-zone

Media card + corner badges

Filter row / filter pad

Star rating

Step header (numbered)

Pill stepper

Particle background

Social auth buttons

Share link / QR

Skeleton set

Divider (1px, 1rem margins)

12 Inconsistencies and uncertain interpretations

- **Three "selected" idioms** (underline, pink pill, white segment) live within two clicks of each other. Deliberate per-context, but not a single rule.
- **Radius is not tokenised.** 18, 20, 25, 28, 35px and 1.1rem/1.5rem/2rem/3rem all appear for card-like surfaces. Any new screen must pick by matching its nearest neighbour, not by a scale.
- **Two accent plums.** #83397f is the global accent, but the Account tab overrides it to #5A1A74 locally, and the active nav link is #520f6a. Which is canonical is **UNKNOWN**.
- **Two gradients for one meaning.** The CTA gradient is defined once as #5A1A74→#8F2356 (left → right) but the onboarding Continue button in the screenshot reads darker on the left and brighter magenta on the right at a slight angle — the exact angle/stops per instance vary.
- **Danger red vs error red.** #fa4666 (danger zone) and #ac1c1c (form errors) coexist; the distinction is destructive-action vs validation, but it is never stated.
- **Font mixing.** Serif (brand), the library sans (UI), Arial (badges), and fantasy (game titles) — four families, one of them OS-dependent. The screenshots show game titles in a slab serif that will not reproduce on every machine.
- **Icon-set mixing.** Lucide stroke icons and Font Awesome solid glyphs appear in the same viewport (settings tabs vs settings rows), so stroke weight and optical size are inconsistent.
- **Clipped copy** on game cards (fixed 30% caption) and on book captions where the frosted strip overlaps the rating.
- **The Interests card breaks the "no border, no shadow" settings rule** by being visually taller than its siblings in a masonry column, producing an intentional-looking but accidental asymmetry.
- **Hover-only affordances** (share icons, "Hide", card scale) cannot be judged for touch parity from these screenshots — **UNKNOWN**.
- **Not determinable at all:** dark mode, focus-ring styling for keyboard users, transition durations beyond the 0.2–0.3s seen in CSS, mobile navbar layout, the Discover / Review / chat surfaces (no screenshot supplied), and real type sizes for the library-owned components (they inherit the component library's own scale).

Rules every future Almonium screen follows

- 1 Cream ground, white float.** Every page starts on #F9F6F5. White is only for raised surfaces. Never put a white page background behind content.
- 2 One primary action per view,** and it is the plum → raspberry gradient pill (radius 9999px, white bold 16px, padding 1.1rem 1.5rem), full width of its column. Everything else is outline, underline or text.
- 3 Round everything.** Interactive elements are pills; containers are 20–35px; nothing below 15px except the 4px inline level chip and 8px micro-badges. No square corners.
- 4 Serif for brand and reading, sans for controls, Arial-style caps for codes.** Never set a form label or button in the serif; never set the wordmark or a nav link in the sans.
- 5 550 for emphasis, 700 only for display.** Body 16px/1.5, long-form 1.6, micro-labels 10px uppercase 650 with tracking.
- 6 One concern per card,** bold 16px title flush top-left, content in a single row or wrapping chip row, the row's action pushed to the far right as a 40px circular outlined icon.
- 7 Spacing in rem steps of 0.5:** 0.5 / 1 / 1.5 / 2rem. 1rem gap inside a card, 1.3em card padding, 2rem between blocks. Use flex/grid gap, never margins between siblings.
- 8 Elevation is shadow, hierarchy is not border.** Two shadows only: ambient for cards, the slightly deeper media shadow for artwork. Hover changes scale (1.01–1.09), never shadow.
- 9 Categorical data is a pastel chip whose colour comes from its own label** — languages, interests, levels. Do not hand-pick chip colours, and do not invent new semantic hues.

- 10 **Dashed border = "add / edit / drop here"**. Solid = a committed value. Keep that contract.
- 11 **Edit in place**. Show the value, offer a pencil, swap the row into a field, save within the same card. No separate edit pages.
- 12 **Every control owns its own loading state** — spinner in place, label hidden, zero layout shift. Page-level waits use skeletons shaped like the real content, radius 12px.
- 13 **Destructive actions are quarantined** in a #ffe3e9 Danger Zone at the end of the column, with a raspberry outline button and a confirmation step. Never inline, never a primary.
- 14 **Premium is the cyan → violet gradient and nothing else**. Locked features stay visible with the limit stated in one plain sentence; upgrade is an invitation, not a lock icon.
- 15 **Personality comes from illustration and copy, not from UI ornament**. Mascots, engraved artwork, particles and a warm second-person voice — while the chrome stays quiet, round and cream.

Extraction only — no new screens, no recolouring, no simplification. Discover, Review and chat were not supplied and are absent from this analysis.